

Incident Classification Matrix

Document Control

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Purpose

This matrix defines how GlobalTech Manufacturing classifies security incidents by severity, the required initial response time for each level, and the escalation and activation rules tied to each classification. It is used by the Security Operations Center (SOC) and Incident Response Team (IRT) at the point of initial assessment and throughout an active incident.

Classification Matrix

Severity	Description	Response Time (Initial Response)	Examples	IRT Activation

Critical	Significant disruption to manufacturing/OT operations, confirmed large-scale breach of personal or sensitive data, imminent safety risk, or organization-wide outage.	Within 30 minutes, 24/7/365	Ransomware affecting production/OT systems; confirmed large-scale customer or employee data breach; safety-impacting compromise of industrial control systems; active attacker with domain admin access; multi-site outage	Full IRT activated immediately, including Executive Sponsor, Legal, DPO, and Communications
High	Significant impact to a business function or limited set of systems, with realistic potential to escalate to Critical.	Within 1 hour, 24/7/365	Malware outbreak contained to a single site or network segment; confirmed unauthorized access to a sensitive system without confirmed mass exfiltration; compromise of a privileged account; targeted spear-phishing with confirmed access	Core IRT activated (Incident Response Manager, Security Analysts, relevant IT/OT leads); Legal and DPO notified and engaged as needed

Medium	Impact limited to a small number of users or a non-critical system; contained or low likelihood of further spread.	Within 4 business hours	Isolated malware on a single workstation; potential data mishandling by an individual; suspicious activity requiring investigation with no confirmed compromise	Security Analyst(s) handle directly; Incident Response Manager notified; escalation only if scope grows
Low	Minor security event with no indication of compromise; logged for visibility and trend analysis.	Within 1 business day	Single blocked intrusion attempt; minor policy violation; confirmed false-positive alert	Logged and closed by SOC; no formal IRT activation required

Escalation Rules

- Any incident may be escalated to a higher severity at any point if new information indicates broader scope, higher sensitivity of affected data, or safety implications
- Any incident suspected to involve personal data must be flagged to the Data Protection Officer regardless of initial severity, to begin the GDPR breach assessment process
- Any incident affecting OT/industrial control systems is automatically evaluated for at least High severity, given potential safety and production impact, even if initial technical scope appears limited
- Two or more simultaneous Medium incidents with a common indicator of compromise must be re-evaluated as a single High or Critical incident

Severity Assignment Responsibility

The on-call Security Analyst assigns the initial classification at intake. The Incident Response Manager confirms or adjusts the classification once the IRT is engaged, and retains authority to escalate or de-escalate throughout the incident lifecycle.

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	2026-08-19	IT Security Team	Initial release, companion to Incident Response Policy POL-SEC-004